

FORGE Phase 1 • Week 7 • Session 21 — Media Insert

For the facilitator. Use alongside "Session 21: Making Amends and Moving Forward" in the Phase 1 Facilitator Guide.

Download the videos: forgementors.org/media.html

Session 21 as written runs about 105 minutes. This insert adds two short videos and one short talk, which fills the session to two hours without changing any of its content. This is the heaviest session of the week. Both videos are narrated in a calm voice and use only cards and quiet scenes. Nothing about any harm is shown or acted out. Have water and tissues out before the men arrive, as the guide asks.

What's in this insert

- **Video 21A, "Making Amends and Moving Forward"** (2 min 13 s). What this session asks, in the guide's words: "This is not punishment." It covers the difference between regret that destroys you and accountability that transforms you, and a reminder of guilt vs. shame. Then it sets punitive accountability against restorative accountability's three questions. It ends on the one-word check-in and holds it for 20 seconds.
- **Video 21B, "Living Amends"** (1 min 30 s). An apology is words; amends are action. It covers the guide's point that when direct amends aren't possible, "it changes the form of amends, not the obligation," then living amends item by item. It closes with the facilitator notes' words for men with long sentences: "Your impact isn't measured by your address. It's measured by your actions." It ends on "the past doesn't get the last word."
- **A short talk:** Marlon Peterson, *Am I not human? A call for criminal justice reform* (TED, recorded 2016, 7 minutes 22 seconds). While serving ten years for his part in a robbery in which two people were killed, he wrote to middle-school students as a mentor. He calls it what gave him "a sense that I was useful." That is living amends, before the word comes up in the session.

Run of show (120 minutes)

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:00	Video 21A, "Making Amends and Moving Forward"	3	Play it as soon as the men are seated.
0:03	Opening Circle	10	As written: the one-word round on the question the video ends on. Note who seems heavy, withdrawn or agitated.
0:13	Instruction: Restorative Accountability	15	The video has set out punitive vs. restorative and the three questions. Take the questions one at a time with the room. Finish on the guide's lines about carrying it "like a responsibility, not like a death sentence."
0:28	Talk: Marlon Peterson, <i>Am I not human?</i> , and discussion	12	Seven and a half minutes of talk, then four or five of discussion (questions below). Introduce it in one sentence: "He served ten years for his part in a robbery where two people died. Listen for what finally made him feel useful."

Time	Segment	Min	Notes
0:40	Instruction: The Ripple Effect	20	As written, and by you. There is no video for this segment on purpose. It needs a person in the room, the pauses, and "Let it be heavy." Close with the guide's guilt-and-shame reminder; Video 21A already put it on screen.
1:00	Video 21B, "Living Amends" , then Amends vs. Apology	10	The video covers apology vs. amends and living amends. Use the rest to connect it to Marlon's letters and to ask: "What does living amends look like on this unit, this week?"
1:10	Exercise: The Impact Awareness Letter	35	As written: instructions, 20 minutes of silent writing, then the guide's words. No forced sharing. If the men saw Quan Huynh's talk in Session 19, they have already heard a letter like this read aloud. His came back unread, and it still mattered.
1:45	Closing Circle	15	As written: "This week, I learned that accountability means...", then the homework.

The talk sits before the Ripple Effect, not after it, so that the guide's own sequence stays unbroken: ripple, then amends, then straight into the letter "while the truth is close to the surface."

Discussion questions for *Am I not human?*

1. Marlon says there were reasons for what he did: "not excuses — but reasons." What is the difference? Where is that line for you? (*Session 19: "My background explains how I got there. It doesn't excuse what I did."*)
2. The letters gave him "a sense that I was useful." What gives a man in here that sense?
3. He mentored young people away from the path he took. How is that different from saying "I'm sorry"? (*Carry the answers into Video 21B.*)

Preview the talk before the session. Marlon names his crime plainly: a robbery attempt in which four people were shot and two were killed. In one sentence he says he was raped at gunpoint at 14. He makes one passing political remark. There is no imagery. In this session especially, tell the men before it plays that it names a killing and a sexual assault. Remind them they can step out for a minute.

Links, and getting a copy you can play without internet

- *Am I not human? A call for criminal justice reform*: **YouTube** (TED): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=D9ZNpt6FVTY> · also on TED.com: https://www.ted.com/talks/marlon_peterson_am_i_not_human_a_call_for_criminal_justice_reform

The same licensing note as Session 19 applies. TED's usage policy allows a single talk in a single lesson; a talk that becomes a standing part of a curriculum may need TED's permission, and TED asks that talks not be scraped. Ask TED (help.ted.com, [licensing](http://licensing.ted.com)) for an offline copy.

Check the talk against the facility's rules for outside media before the session.

Checklist additions

- ☐ Videos 21A and 21B and the talk loaded on the playback device and tested with sound
- ☐ Talk previewed and cleared under the facility's media rules
- ☐ Water and tissues out before the session; a plan for anyone who needs to step out